

MICHELLE DUELL

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Professional Summary

Security analyst, SANS Cyber Academy Scholar, and intelligence professional with an active TS/SCI clearance. Captained the second-place team at the 2026 USCC National Cyber Bowl, adding to first-place finishes in national cybersecurity competitions. Eight years of operational targeting and multi-source intelligence experience, a published 16-report threat intelligence series from a 28-day cloud honeypot, a 45+ agent LLM pipeline for threat scenario production, and 600+ adversarial evaluations of frontier AI models. Building toward AI-enabled security operations, detection engineering, and threat intelligence roles focused on defensive AI capability.

Certifications

GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH) | 2026

GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC) | 2025

GIAC Advisory Board (90%+ exam score) | 2025

CSA Trusted AI Safety Expert (TAISE) | 2026

Professional Experience

Senior AI Safety Evaluator | Handshake AI | Remote (Contract) | 2026 to Present

- Test frontier AI models against their safety limits through structured red teaming, probing model behavior against safety policies and documenting reproducible findings
- Completed 600+ evaluations spanning red teaming, conversation evaluations, and harm assessments

AI Workflow Engineer & Threat Content Analyst (Volunteer) | KC7 Foundation | Remote | 2026 to Present

- Designed and built an agentic LLM pipeline of 45+ specialized agents, cutting threat scenario production time from roughly three weeks to roughly three hours
- Review threat scenarios and investigative workflows for technical accuracy before publication, validating that attacker techniques reflect realistic TTPs and that investigative steps reproduce as written
- Authored AeroDrift Motors, a published game at the Challenging difficulty level, and contributed to 6+ published games on KC7's free cybersecurity education platform

Security Analyst & Researcher (Independent) | 2025 to Present

- Deployed T-Pot Community Edition on GCP for 28 days, collecting 96M+ events across a fully exposed attack surface. Queried raw Elasticsearch data daily to track CVE exploitation trends, active campaigns, and credential attack patterns, and published a 16-report CTI series at aerobytes.io
- Completed 27 end-to-end intrusion investigations (400+ hours) on the KC7 cyber platform, pivoting through email, DNS, endpoint, and authentication telemetry with KQL in Azure Data Explorer to reconstruct full attack chains. Published writeups of 3 investigations
- Test web applications on live in-scope bug bounty programs using browser developer tools and manual analysis, informed by OWASP Top 10 vulnerability classes

Intelligence Analyst | U.S. Army Reserve | Atlanta, GA | 2018 to Present

- Conduct strategic and operational-level targeting as Joint Intelligence Targeting Staff (J2T) member supporting combatant command operations
- Lead Joint Targeting Team of 9 personnel, coordinating cross-functional intelligence production and delivering targeting packages to operational commanders
- Correlate multi-source data to identify adversary TTPs, synthesizing classified and open-source intelligence into actionable threat assessments

Cybersecurity Projects & Skills

- **AeroLab Triage Agent** | Built a local LLM triage pipeline in Python that pulls Elastic SIEM alerts, enriches them with process and authentication telemetry, maps them to ATT&CK techniques, and returns structured verdicts through Ollama, evaluated against known-answer identity attack simulations and benign activity in AeroLab
- **AeroLab v2** | Designed and deployed a segmented purple team environment across two Proxmox nodes with pfSense, Windows Server 2022 with intentionally misconfigured Active Directory, Elastic SIEM 9.x, and Velociraptor, authoring ATT&CK-mapped attack simulations for Kerberoasting, AS-REP roasting, Pass-the-Hash, and DCSync, generating the payloads and traffic, and analyzing the resulting telemetry in Elastic SIEM
- **Ghidra Function ID Pipeline** | Built a repeatable pipeline generating Ghidra Function ID databases for glibc across four Ubuntu releases (29,578 functions), raising named functions in a stripped test binary from 7 to 144

CTF & Cybersecurity Competition Results

- **1st Place Overall & 1st Place Industry Professional** | 2026 WiCyS Conference CTF
- **1st Place** | 2026 Tenable x WiCyS CTF
- **2nd Place, Team Captain** | 2026 USCC National Cyber Bowl, recognized in Washington, DC
- **2nd Place** | 2026 Elastic Security CTF
- **2nd Place** | 2025 WiCyS x Target Cyber Defense Challenge
- **5th Place & Runner-Up Most Creative Report** | 2025 SANS Holiday Hack Challenge

Speaking Engagements

“Reverse Engineering with Ghidra for DNS Exfiltration”

- WiCyS 2026 National Conference | Washington, DC | 2026
- WiCyS San Diego Cyber Speaker Series | Virtual | 2026

Technical Writing & Publications

Published 35+ technical writeups at aerobytes.io/writeups covering CTF solutions, honeypot findings, reverse engineering, and homelab infrastructure, including a 16-report threat intelligence series.

Education

SANS Cyber Academy | SANS Technology Institute | 2026

AWS AI & ML Scholar, Agent Engineer Nanodegree | Udacity | In Progress

Undergraduate Certificate, Computers and Networking | American Military University | 2022

Associate of Applied Science, Intelligence Operations | Cochise College | 2019

Master of Music Education and Bachelor of Music Performance | Lamar University

Professional Affiliations

VetSec | WiCyS Representative | 2025 to Present

Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS) | 2025 to Present

Military Cyber Professionals Association | 2025 to Present

Military Intelligence Corps Association | 2018 to Present

Other Work Experience

OSINT Researcher (Volunteer) | National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency | GEMINI Program | 2020 to Present

- Queried and validated geospatial datasets with Overpass API and OpenStreetMap, contributing 5,000+ map edits supporting critical infrastructure mapping and intelligence community requirements
- Designed and administered 15 critical infrastructure mapping campaigns to sustain team readiness and support operational intelligence

Music Educator and Professional Musician | Various Organizations | 2004 to 2015

- Led a band program of approximately 500 students, earning multiple regional and state recognitions
- Performed as Assistant Principal Clarinet in three professional symphony orchestras